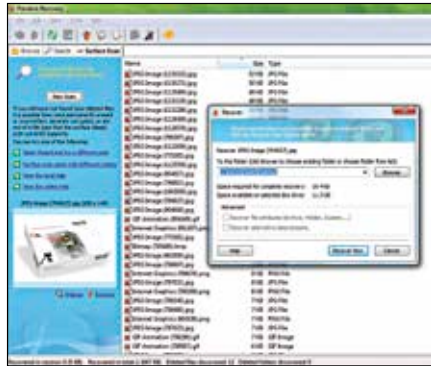


DVDs, CDs, memory cards and even your iPod! Recuva's file recovery wizard comes in handy for searching for specific types of files and looking for them in precise spots. Any files that are found are listed (with previews for images) and can immediately be restored with just a couple of clicks. It also has an advanced mode, which provides a much deeper scan as well as the option of wiping out files so that they can never be undeleted again. This is a useful feature for people recovering data only to ensure that particular files are truly dead and gone.

2. **Testdisk (Windows/Mac/Linux):** A powerful Open Source tool, this software is available across all platforms. It's an extremely powerful tool that not only lets you recover accidentally deleted data, but also helps rebuild your boot sector, fix FAT tables and find lost partitions to help locate data, among other things. The only downside to this tool is that it has no GUI, and hence isn't extremely intuitive.
3. **Pandora Recovery (Windows):** If, however, a really helpful wizard and an easy-to-use, interactive UI are your priorities, then Pandora Recovery is a suitable choice. It's extremely user friendly, and though the initial standard search may not seem to recover many files, the advanced 'Surface Scan' should do the trick and recover most files. The Explorer-like folder view and excellent search tool make recovering data with this software a breeze.



4. **PhotoRec (Windows/Mac/Linux):** This software is actually bundled along with Testdisk, but it deserves a separate mention, since it's a safer alternative for times when deep disk recovery or screening through your partitions isn't required. This is another extremely powerful tool that doesn't really have the best user interface, but it makes up for this shortcoming by its ability to work with most file systems and device types and, despite its name, isn't just relegated to photos.

There you have it. Hopefully, these software solutions are good enough for your problem. We wish you a quick recovery. 